Brief for Aakriti Mainali

SPLASH, accessibility of learning material. November 13 to 26, 2026

Your role

Interview guides, the comparison of SAS and published evidence, and requirements.

Why this matters

The professor's feedback was clear. Start from the problem, not the solution. Follow for whom, objectives, difficulties, why, consequences, and only then how. Write what we did, not what we will do. Make decisions and assign responsibility. Every member's contribution must be visible, because project grades are lowered when a member's contribution cannot be verified.

Our problem statement today

Blind and low vision university students must learn from lecture material made for sighted students. We do not yet know what actually stops them, why, or what it costs them.

Right now this is a hypothesis, not a proven problem. Published evidence points to it, but nobody local has confirmed it. Today's job is to decide, as a team, whether it is valid enough to keep investigating and which hypotheses we test.

Today's task for everyone, Friday November 13

1. Read the problem statement above and the hypotheses below.
2. Read your assigned sources (your section below). For each hypothesis write one line. Supported, against, or no evidence in your sources, with source numbers.
3. Answer three questions in writing. Is the problem statement valid or only a hypothesis? Which hypothesis is strongest from your sources? Which one is weakest or missing evidence?
4. Bring this to the team meeting tonight. The team agrees on the hypothesis list and records the decision in `docs/decisions-log.md`.
5. Commit your notes as `research/summaries/<your-name>-hypotheses.md` and add a row to `docs/daily-log.md` from your own GitHub account.

The hypotheses to test

#	Hypothesis	Evidence so far
H1	Math, graphs, diagrams and image only slides are unreadable with screen readers and braille displays	Strong. Our PDF scan, studies, students, scientists and posts
H2	Accessible material reaches students too late to keep up	Mixed. Students report delays, published turnaround is 2 to 10 business days
H3	Making material accessible costs staff and instructors a lot of manual time	Some. Job postings and tool reviews, no measured hours
H4	Instructors do not know how or that they need to make material accessible	Repeated in studies and student accounts

#	Hypothesis	Evidence so far
H5	Instructors share PDFs when the original file would work better	Some posts
H6	Students' screen readers, braille displays and devices fail on the material as it is shared	Partly. Tools work on structured content, fail on images and untagged PDFs
H7	The SAS request process itself causes the delay	Unknown
H8	Live lectures, board work and pointing, are a bigger barrier than files	Some posts and student accounts
H9	Attitudes and low expectations block students more than material	Some scientists say so
H10	Students spend a lot of extra time because of this	A few examples
H11	It is not a real problem here because SAS already handles it well	Unknown. This is the null hypothesis, we must test it honestly

These match questions A to K in `research/research-questions.md`.

The process we follow

We use an iterative, risk driven lifecycle, in the style of the spiral model. We chose it because our biggest risk is not technical. It is that the problem is not what we think. A risk driven lifecycle deals with the biggest risk first and only moves on when it is reduced. Waterfall would fix requirements before we know the problem. Full Scrum assumes a known product backlog, which we do not have yet.

Phase	Dates	What we do	Exit criterion
1 Problem validation	Nov 13 to 17	Hypotheses, reading, SAS, students, instructors	Each hypothesis marked supported, rejected or unknown. Team verdict recorded
2 Requirements and scope	Nov 18 to 19	User needs, requirements traced to needs, scope, success measures with baselines	Requirements agreed and traced to evidence
3 Design and prototypes	Nov 20 to 23	Two or three prototypes, each tied to a confirmed cause	Each prototype runs on real course material
4 Evaluation	Nov 24 to 25	Test against success measures, before and after	Results table complete
5 Defense	Nov 26	Report, slides, demo	Each member presents their part

At the end of each phase the team reviews the evidence and records a decision. If evidence rejects a hypothesis we change direction and record why. That is not a failure. It is the process working.

Your sources

`research/block2/04-studies.md` (13 studies), `research/candidates/05-papers.md` (10 papers) and `research/candidates/02-institutions.md` (10 sources). The full list is in `research/reading-list.md`.

Your day by day tasks

Day	Task
Fri Nov 13	Hypothesis review of your sources. Draft interview guides for SAS staff, students and instructors. Deadline 9 pm.
Sat Nov 14	Finalize the guides after team comments. Keep reading. Deadline 9 pm.
Sun Nov 15	Write your one page six question summary. Deadline 9 pm.
Mon Nov 16	SAS meeting with Abhinav. Notes in `research/interviews/` the same day.
Tue Nov 17	Compare the SAS notes with the published evidence. What matches and what differs. Deadline 6 pm.
Wed Nov 18	Functional and non functional requirements, each traced to a user need and its evidence. Deadline 9 pm.
Thu Nov 19	Team meeting to choose prototype directions. Write the design of your prototype. Deadline 11 pm.
Nov 20 to 23	Build your prototype. Commit and log daily.
Tue Nov 24	Test your prototype against the success measures.
Wed Nov 25	Results table, before and after, for every success measure. Deadline 6 pm.
Thu Nov 26	Final report, slides, demo. Present your part.

Hints

- Build each guide on the six questions, then add the hypothesis questions that person can answer. SAS covers H2, H3, H6, H7, H11. Instructors cover H3, H4, H5. Students cover H1, H2, H6, H8, H9, H10, H11.
- Keep guides to 8 to 10 questions so a meeting fits in 30 minutes.
- SAS questions to include. How many students use alternate formats? Which course material takes longest to convert? What is the turnaround for lecture slides? What part is manual?
- Most of your studies are abstract level. Open the key ones fully before relying on them.
- A requirement must point to a need and to evidence. No requirement without a source.

You are done each day when

- Your output file is in the repo.
- Your row is in `docs/daily-log.md`.
- Both are committed from your own account.

Rules for everyone

- Write in past tense in reports. We interviewed, we found, we decided.

- No solution words before Thursday November 19.
- Only cite a source you have opened yourself.
- Record what goes against us too.
- Every task ends with a file in the repo and a row in `docs/daily-log.md`, committed from your own account the same day.
- If you miss a deadline, write why in the log the same day.
- New sources you find, YouTube, podcasts, papers, articles, interviews, go at the end of `research/reading-list.md` with title, link and two or three lines of notes.

Where things are

- Repository https://github.com/Abhinavxox/Splash-Project
- All sources numbered `research/reading-list.md`
- Research questions `research/research-questions.md`
- Interview log and template `research/interviews/README.md`
- Team task sheet `docs/team-task-sheet.pdf`